ELECTRONIC PRESS KIT

VARUN NIMBOLKAR

Sitarist / Composer / Producer



Classical roots. An evolving sound.

Pune, India • Acoustic and electric sitar • Original music and live performance

A modern voice for the sitar

Varun Nimbolkar is a Pune-based composer, producer, performing sitar player and vocalist. He brings Indian classical training into conversation with electronic music, ambient soundscapes, rock and contemporary grooves.

His classical foundation includes more than a decade studying under Ustad Usman Khan, along with time with Pt. Vijay Koparkar and mentorship under Pt. Kushal Das. That background informs a practice that moves between acoustic and electric sitar, effects pedals, live looping and original production.

Across recordings and stages, Varun treats the sitar as a lead voice in evolving musical stories. His independent releases include Bah Bah Black Sheep, Dreams for a Living and Watching Her Dance.



From intimate rooms to festival stages

Varun presents two live formats that combine expressive sitar playing with contemporary production.

SOLO SETS

An intimate exploration of acoustic and electric sitar, ethnic electronica, ambient textures and live looping. The format adapts to listening rooms, cultural venues, festivals and curated events.

THE SITARA DEVI PROJECT

A full-ensemble show with The Sitara Devi & her Bois, built for a larger, high-energy stage experience.

Selected stages & tours

A six-city India tour; Magnetic Music at ZLB, Bengaluru; and a May 2026 UK tour through Manchester and London. The UK run included a 90-minute headline solo set at The Nehru Centre, the cultural wing of the High Commission of India, and appearances at Mind Body Spirit Festival, Happy Place Festival and World Yoga Festival.



Music across borders of genre

BAH BAH BLACK SHEEP

An exploratory five-track EP placing Indian classical phrasing within electronic and cinematic soundscapes.

DREAMS FOR A LIVING

An EP in which sitar-led composition meets rock and blues resonance.

WATCHING HER DANCE

An acoustic single featured in Rolling Stone India and selected for FabIndia's nationwide in-store playlist for a 12-month run.

THODA SA — GUNDA feat. VARUN NIMBOLKAR & UNKILL JI

Sitar contribution and production for the Azadi Records release. The official music video is available on YouTube.

THE UNPOSTED LETTER

A collaboration with vocalist Saee Tembhekar, covered by Rockstreet Journal and Rolling Stone India.

MAYA — DEREK & THE CATS

Guest sitar on the track from People to Meet, Places to See.

Other collaborations include projects with Tienas and singer-composer Amritha Thankachy.

Watch Thoda Sa

04 / BEYOND THE STAGE

A collaborator in sound

Varun works with artists, labels, brands and film creators as a composer, producer and session musician. His approach blends sitar textures with hip-hop, electronica, blues rock and indie pop.

BEATOVEN AI

Contributed a custom library of more than 400 sitar loops and phrases for Beatoven’s music composition platform.

FABINDIA

Watching Her Dance was selected for continuous nationwide in-store rotation for twelve months.

Audience at a glance

400,000+ all-time streams across major digital platforms, including catalogue under The Ashwatth Project alias. 16,000+ peak monthly listeners across Spotify and streaming networks. 1,300+ followers across his independent music catalogue.

These are historical milestones from the supplied artist content, rather than live counters.

In the conversation

Homegrown Magazine · October 2025

Indian Experimental Fusion EP Doubles Down On Emotive Storytelling

The Indian Music Diaries · October 2025

Bah Bah Black Sheep Sits Comfortably Between Indian Classical and Electronica

The Indian Music Diaries · January 2024

Dreams For A Living EP Melds Classical Essence With Rock Resonance

Homegrown Magazine · February 2026

Art That Inspires: 7 Homegrown Musicians On The Books That Shaped Their Sound

The Indian Music Diaries · June 2021

Singles Roundup #29: Diversify Your Playlist With These Latest Tracks

Further coverage of Derek & The Cats' People to Meet, Places to See also mentions Varun's sitar contribution to "Maya".

06 / BOOKINGS & LINKS

Let’s make something sound

Available for live performances, solo sitar sets, ensemble shows, studio sessions, composition and cross-genre collaborations.

For booking enquiries, include the proposed date, city or venue, performance format, event details and budget where available.

Booking email: varun.nimbolkar@gmail.com

Contact & booking form

Spotify

Apple Music

YouTube

Instagram

Gallery

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